

access the shared folder as though it were located on your hard drive. If you intend work within this shared folder regularly, tick and enable the 'Reconnect at Logon' option, to make the drive mapping permanent.

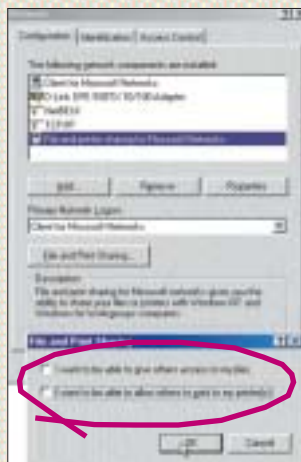
Now these drives will be fully accessible through DOS or any older Windows programs.

Searching for a server

If you are working on a large LAN, then getting into a shared network resource or folder would mean making your way through the Network Neighbourhood and the various workgroups. The entire list of computers across the network could take quite a while to build up; instead, go to the address bar and type `\\computer_name` to directly connect with and browse the remote computer. You can also go to the **Start > Run** menu and type `\\computer_name` to access the computer. This is the Universal Naming Convention (UNC) style network name.

File and Printer Sharing

To share resources across the network, you will need to enable the 'File and Printer sharing' option. If you do not intend to share any folders or printers from your computer, you can uninstall the same for Microsoft Networks. To do this, go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel > Network** and click on the File Sharing. Uncheck both the 'Give access to files' and 'Give access to printer'. You will have to restart your computer for the changes to



Removing File and Printer Sharing Services

take place.

Now no one will be able to access any files on your machine, since your computer will not appear on the network. You will, however, be able to access files and folders on other computers as long as Client for Microsoft Networks is installed.

Protecting your shares

To ensure safe sharing of your network shares, you can restrict access to your shared resources. Right-click on the folder or drive you want to share, and select Sharing. Here you can set the level of access. You can mark a folder as read-only, give it full access and assign a password for each. A quick way of hiding your shared folders is to add the '\$' sign as the last character in the share name. This way even though the folder appears to be hidden from public view, it can still be accessed and viewed—so if you really have to lock it

down and protect it, add in a password too.

Messaging across the LAN

You can send a quick message across the LAN using a standard tool within Windows. WinPopUp is a standard and easy-to-use messaging utility within Windows. To use WinPopUp, go to **Start > Run** and type in `winpopup` in the Open field, and click OK. This will open the WinPopUp window. To send a message through WinPopUp, click on Send—



Using the WinPopUP messaging utility

this opens up the Send Message window. Type message in the Message text field, and the name of recipient (the computer's name) and click on OK. Incoming messages are also displayed in the WinPopUp window. Keep in mind that for the recipient to be able to receive your message, he or she would also need to have WinPopUp running.

Firewall

Windows XP comes with a firewall known as the Internet Connection Firewall or ICF. ICF provides only inbound protection—unlike a full-fledged firewall, it only monitors data coming into your machine from the Internet. To



Configuring the ICF

turn on ICF, go to the Control panel and select Network Connections. Open this, and right-click on the displayed connection, and click on Properties. Under the Advanced tab, you can enable ICF. While the default settings may work fine, you may want to tweak the settings. Click on the Settings button to access all the ICF features and settings. You can fine tune the network services under the Services tab, set logging details under Security Logging and details about ICMP under the ICMP (Internet Control Message Protocol) tab.

ICF - Do you need it?

Keep in mind that ICF is for use only with a direct connection to the Internet, such as a dial-up or cable modem connection. This means that computers connected to the Internet through a LAN or Internet Connection Sharing (ICS) or a hardware router don't need an ICF. Moreover, you may tend to have some trouble with networking with other computers on a